

GUJARAT ORIGIN

Methi Thepla

Spiced Fenugreek Flatbread
Served with Sweet-Tangy Gujarati Kadhi

AUTHENTIC RECIPE · STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE · PRINTABLE DIGITAL COOKBOOK

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Methi Thepla

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ABOUT THIS BOOK

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Nutrition values are estimates. Cooking times vary with equipment and ingredients. Readers with allergies or dietary restrictions should check every ingredient label before cooking.

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THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

The Bread That Travels Anywhere

Thepla holds a special status in Gujarati cooking as the region's definitive travel food — a spiced, fenugreek-flecked flatbread that stays soft and edible for days without refrigeration, making it the natural choice for long train journeys, pilgrimages, and any trip where fresh cooking wouldn't be possible. Generations of Gujarati travelers have packed stacks of thepla wrapped in cloth, a practice so common it's become something of a cultural shorthand for Gujarati identity on the move.

At home, thepla is equally beloved as an everyday breakfast or light meal, most classically paired with Gujarati kadhi — a version of the yogurt-gram flour curry distinct from its Punjabi and Bihari cousins found elsewhere in this cookbook series, defined by a thinner consistency and Gujarat's signature sweet-tangy balance, achieved with a touch of sugar alongside the yogurt's natural tang.

Together, thepla and kadhi represent something close to Gujarati comfort food at its most essential: a portable, keeps-well bread paired with a light, soothing curry, equally at home on a cross-country train as on a Tuesday morning breakfast table.

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THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

The Bread That Travels Anywhere, continued

CULTURAL NOTES & OCCASIONS

Gujarat's definitive travel food, prized for staying fresh and soft for days without refrigeration, historically packed for long journeys and pilgrimages. Gujarati kadhi is distinct from other regional kadhi styles featured elsewhere in this cookbook series, defined by its thinner consistency and characteristic sweet-tangy balance. The thepla-kadhi combination represents Gujarati comfort food in its most essential, everyday form. A pairing that bridges practical travel food and cherished home cooking within the same culinary tradition.

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AT A GLANCE

Equipment & preparation

25m	30m	4	Med
ACTIVE PREP	COOK TIME	SERVINGS	DIFFICULTY

Recommended equipment

- Mixing bowls
- Rolling pin
- Heavy tava or cast-iron skillet
- Large pot, for the kadhi
- Whisk
- Small pan for the kadhi tempering

STORAGE & MAKE-AHEAD

Thepla keeps at room temperature for up to 3 days, or refrigerated for a week, which is precisely why it's so valued as travel food. Gujarati kadhi is best enjoyed fresh but keeps refrigerated for up to 2 days — reheat gently without boiling hard.

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WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients

For the thepla

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Whole wheat flour (atta)	2 cups	250 g	2 katori
Fresh fenugreek leaves (methi), chopped	1 cup	60 g	1 katori
Besan (gram flour)	¼ cup	30 g	¼ katori
Turmeric powder	½ tsp	1.5 g	½ chammach
Red chili powder	½ tsp	1.5 g	½ chammach
Sugar	1 tsp	4 g	1 chammach
Yogurt	2 tbsp	30 g	2 chammach
Oil	2 tbsp	30 ml	2 chammach
Salt	¾ tsp	4.5 g	to taste
Water, as needed	¼ cup approx.	60 ml approx.	¼ katori approx.
Oil, for cooking	3 tbsp	45 ml	3 chammach

For the gujarati kadhi

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Plain yogurt	1½ cups	360 g	1½ katori
Besan (gram flour)	2 tbsp	15 g	2 tbsp
Water	3 cups	720 ml	3 katori

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WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients, continued

For the gujarati kadhi (cont.)

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Ginger-green chili paste	1 tsp	5 g	1 chammach
Sugar	1½ tbsp	18 g	1½ chammach
Salt	¾ tsp	4.5 g	to taste
Oil or ghee	1 tbsp	15 g	1 chammach
Mustard seeds	½ tsp	2 g	½ chammach
Cumin seeds	½ tsp	2 g	½ chammach
Cinnamon stick	1 inch	1 inch	1 inch
Cloves	2	2	2
Curry leaves	1 sprig	8–10 leaves	1 sprig
Fresh coriander, chopped, for garnish	2 tbsp	8 g	2 tbsp

SUBSTITUTIONS & SOURCING

Fresh fenugreek leaves are worth seeking out at South Asian grocers for authentic thepla; dried kasuri methi, rehydrated, is a workable substitute in a pinch, using about 3 tablespoons. This recipe requires only common pantry staples for the kadhi, making it accessible for cooks with basic access to Indian spices and gram flour.

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STEP BY STEP · PART ONE

Making the Thepla

01 MAKE THE DOUGH

Combine the whole wheat flour, chopped fenugreek leaves, besan, turmeric, chili powder, sugar, yogurt, oil, and salt. Gradually add water, kneading to a smooth, soft dough. Rest for 15 minutes.

02 ROLL AND COOK

Divide the dough into 8 portions and roll each into a thin round, about 6 inches / 15 cm across. Cook on a hot tava with a little oil on each side, until golden-brown spots appear, about 2–3 minutes total per thepla.

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STEP BY STEP · PART ONE

Making the Thepla, continued



Chef tip. thepla should be rolled thinner than a typical paratha — this thinness is part of why it keeps so well for travel.

COOKING CHECKPOINT

Properly cooked thepla should be pliable and soft, with light golden-brown spots on both sides, not crisp or cracker-like.

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STEP BY STEP · PART TWO

Making the Gujarati Kadhi

03 WHISK THE BASE

Whisk the yogurt and besan together until completely smooth, then gradually whisk in the water, ginger-green chili paste, sugar, and salt.

04 SIMMER GENTLY

Pour into a large pot and bring to a gentle boil, stirring frequently to prevent the besan from settling. Reduce heat and simmer for 15–18 minutes, until slightly thickened but still notably thin and pourable.



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Making the Gujarati Kadhi, continued

Texture indicator. Gujarati kadhi should remain thin and soupy, distinctly lighter than Punjabi or Bihari kadhi styles — resist reducing it too much.

05 ADD THE TEMPERING

Heat oil or ghee in a small pan, add mustard seeds, letting them pop, then cumin seeds, cinnamon, cloves, and curry leaves, letting everything sizzle until fragrant. Pour the tempering over the kadhi.

06 GARNISH AND SERVE

Finish with fresh coriander just before serving.

MISTAKE TO AVOID

Boiling the kadhi too vigorously can cause the yogurt to split. Keep it at a gentle simmer throughout, stirring regularly.

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SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve



Traditional Style

- Served together — thepla torn and dipped into the sweet-tangy kadhi, a classic Gujarati breakfast or light meal.
- Thepla alone is a beloved travel food, packed for journeys without needing the kadhi.

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SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve, continued

Family Style

- A comforting, easy family breakfast, especially on weekends when there's time to make both components fresh.

Modern Pairing

- Thepla works well as a wrap for vegetables or paneer, beyond its traditional role alongside kadhi.

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RESTAURANT-GRADE TRICKS

Chef secrets

Getting Both Right

- Thepla dough with yogurt worked in stays soft even after cooking and cooling, which is essential to its travel-food reputation.
- Gujarati kadhi's thinner consistency and sweeter profile are intentional regional characteristics — don't try to thicken or de-sweeten it to match other regional kadhi styles.

Make-Ahead & Meal Prep

- Thepla dough can be made a day ahead and refrigerated; cooked thepla itself keeps for days, making batch cooking very practical.
- Kadhi is best made fresh close to serving, though leftovers reheat reasonably well over gentle heat.

RESTAURANT TRICK

Some households add a small amount of grated bottle gourd or grated cabbage to the thepla dough for extra moisture and nutrition — a common practical variation.

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BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ

APPROXIMATE NUTRITION, PER SERVING

310 kcal	10 g	40 g	12 g	5 g
CALORIES	PROTEIN	CARBOHYDRATES	FAT	FIBER

Estimates only; actual values vary with oil and portion size.

ALLERGEN GUIDE

Contains, based on the ingredient list: Dairy, Gluten, Mustard. Check packaged spices and asafoetida, which may contain wheat, and verify against your own ingredients.

REGIONAL VARIATIONS

Methi Thepla	the classic version featured here, using fresh fenugreek leaves.
Dudhi Thepla	a variation using grated bottle gourd instead of or alongside fenugreek.
Plain Kadhi	some households make a simpler kadhi without the whole spice tempering for a milder version.

Why does thepla keep so well compared to other flatbreads?

The combination of yogurt in the dough and the thin rolling technique helps thepla stay soft and pliable for days, unlike thicker breads that dry out quickly.

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BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ, continued

Can I make kadhi without sugar?

The sweet element is a defining characteristic of Gujarati-style kadhi; reducing it significantly moves the dish closer to other regional kadhi styles rather than the authentic Gujarati version.

Is this meal very spicy?

No — both thepla and kadhi are mild, comforting dishes, with gentle warmth rather than significant heat.

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REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary



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REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary, continued

GLOSSARY

Thepla	a spiced, fenugreek-flecked flatbread, prized as Gujarati travel food.
Kadhi	a tangy yogurt and gram flour curry, with a distinctly thin, sweet-tangy Gujarati style.
Methi	Gujarati/Hindi for fenugreek leaves, the signature flavor of this thepla.
Chaas	spiced buttermilk, another common pairing with thepla.

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PRINTABLE RECIPE CARD

Methi Thepla

25m	30m
ACTIVE PREP	COOK TIME
4	Med
SERVINGS	DIFFICULTY

THEPLA

Whole wheat flour	250 g
Fresh fenugreek leaves	60 g
Besan	30 g
Turmeric powder	1.5 g
Red chili powder	1.5 g
Sugar	4 g
Yogurt	30 g
Oil	30 ml
Salt	4.5 g
Water	60 ml approx.
Oil	45 ml

GUJARATI KADHI

Plain yogurt	360 g
Besan	15 g
Water	720 ml
Ginger-green chili paste	5 g
Sugar	18 g
Salt	4.5 g
Oil or ghee	15 g
Mustard seeds	2 g
Cumin seeds	2 g
Cinnamon stick	1 inch
Cloves	2
Curry leaves	8–10 leaves
Fresh coriander	8 g

METHOD

01 **Make the dough.** Combine the whole wheat flour, chopped fenugreek leaves, besan, turmeric, chili powder, sugar, yogurt, oil, and salt.

02 **Roll and cook.** Divide the dough into 8 portions and roll each into a thin round, about 6 inches / 15 cm across.

03 **Whisk the base.** Whisk the yogurt and besan together until completely smooth, then gradually whisk in the water, ginger-green chili paste, sugar, and salt.

04 **Simmer gently.** Pour into a large pot and bring to a gentle boil, stirring frequently to prevent the besan from settling.

05 **Add the tempering.** Heat oil or ghee in a small pan, add mustard seeds, letting them pop, then cumin seeds, cinnamon, cloves, and curry leaves, letting everything sizzle until fragrant.

06 **Garnish and serve.** Finish with fresh coriander just before serving.

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BEFORE YOU SHOP

Shopping list

☐ Whole wheat flour	250 g	☐ Fresh fenugreek leaves	60 g
☐ Besan	see recipe	☐ Turmeric powder	1.5 g
☐ Red chili powder	1.5 g	☐ Sugar	see recipe
☐ Yogurt	30 g	☐ Oil	see recipe
☐ Salt	see recipe	☐ Plain yogurt	360 g
☐ Ginger-green chili paste	5 g	☐ Oil or ghee	15 g
☐ Mustard seeds	2 g	☐ Cumin seeds	2 g
☐ Cinnamon stick	1 inch	☐ Cloves	2
☐ Curry leaves	8–10 leaves	☐ Fresh coriander	8 g

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